DECIMALS — ADDITION & SUBTRACTION

Grade 3 Mathematics Lesson

What Are Decimals?

Decimals are numbers with parts smaller than one.

- Look at the number line: 0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3 … all the way to 1!
- The dot in the middle is called a **decimal point**.
- Decimals help us show amounts between whole numbers.

Understanding Decimal Place Value

Number	Ones	.	Tenths	Hundredths
3.25	**3**	**.**	**2**	**5**

Why Do We Use Decimals?

■ **Money**	■25.50
■ **Length**	1.5 meters
■ **Time**	9.8 seconds

ADDITION OF DECIMALS

Adding Decimals — The Key Rule

Always **line up the decimal points** before adding! This keeps tenths under tenths and hundredths under hundredths.

Worked Example 1: 1.40 + 2.75

1.40 + 2.75

Step 1: 0 + 5 = 5 (hundredths)

Step 2: 4 + 7 = 11 (tenths) → carry 1

Step 3: 1 + 2 + 1 = 4 (ones)

✓ Answer: 4.15

Worked Example 2: 3.25 + 4.60

3.25 + 4.60

Step 1: 5 + 0 = 5 (hundredths)

Step 2: 2 + 6 = 8 (tenths)

Step 3: 3 + 4 = 7 (ones)

✓ Answer: 7.85

Worked Example 3: 5.75 + 2.85

5.75 + 2.85

Step 1: 5 + 5 = 10 → write 0, carry 1

Step 2: 7 + 8 + 1 = 16 (tenths) → write 6, carry 1

Step 3: 5 + 2 + 1 = 8 (ones)

✓ Answer: 8.60

Addition Practice Time!

Remember: Line up the decimal points first!

1. 2.3 + 1.45 = _____	**2. 4.6 + 3.2 = _____**
3. 0.75 + 0.25 = _____	**4. 6.1 + 2.9 = _____**

SUBTRACTION OF DECIMALS

Subtracting Decimals — The Key Rule

Just like addition, always **line up the decimal points** before subtracting. Then subtract each column carefully, borrowing when needed.

Worked Example 1: 4.50 – 2.35

4.50 – 2.35

Step 1: 0 – 5 → can't do it! Borrow: 10 – 5 = 5 (hundredths)

Step 2: 4 – 1 (borrowed) – 3 = 0 (tenths) → write 1

Step 3: 4 – 2 = 2 (ones)

✓ Answer: 2.15

Worked Example 2: 6.4 – 3.25

6.4 – 3.25 → rewrite as 6.40 – 3.25

Step 1: 0 – 5 → borrow! 10 – 5 = 5 (hundredths)

Step 2: 3 – 2 = 1 (tenths)

Step 3: 6 – 3 = 3 (ones)

✓ Answer: 3.15

Worked Example 3: 7.85 – 4.6

7.85 – 4.6 → rewrite as 7.85 – 4.60

Step 1: 5 – 0 = 5 (hundredths)

Step 2: 8 – 6 = 2 (tenths)

Step 3: 7 – 4 = 3 (ones)

✓ Answer: 3.25

Subtraction Practice Time!

1. 5.5 – 2.25 = _____	2. 8.3 – 3.1 = _____
3. 4.75 – 1.5 = _____	4. 6.9 – 4.4 = _____

Tips to Remember

1. Always line up the decimal points before adding or subtracting.

2. Add or subtract digits in each place value carefully — hundredths first, then tenths, then ones.

3. Don't forget to bring down the decimal point in your answer.

4. When a column needs borrowing in subtraction, borrow from the column to the left.

5. If one number has fewer decimal places, add a zero as a placeholder (e.g., 6.4 → 6.40).

Summary — What We Learned Today

• Decimals are numbers with parts less than one.

• The dot in the middle is called the **decimal point**.

• Always align decimal points for addition and subtraction.

• Add or subtract digits in each place value carefully.

• Practice makes perfect — keep trying!

You Can Do It! ■

Math is fun when you try your best!